Northwind Traders

Sales Performance & Customer Retention Review

Internal Business Analysis Report | Fiscal Years 2012–2023

Prepared by: Business Analytics Team | Distribution: Sales Leadership, Regional Managers | Classification: Internal Use Only

Executive Summary

Northwind Traders generated total net revenue of **$448.4M** across **16,282 orders** placed by **93 active customer accounts** between July 2012 and October 2023. Revenue has remained broadly stable on a year-over-year basis since 2013, fluctuating in a $38M–$41M band, with a notable decline to $33.1M in 2023 — the most recent full year of data. This report summarizes performance across product categories, regions, sales personnel, and shipping partners, and flags several patterns that merit follow-up from a customer retention standpoint.

1. Revenue by Product Category

Beverages remain the strongest category by a wide margin, generating $92.2M in net revenue across 14,828 line items — roughly 20.6% of total company revenue. Confections and Meat/Poultry follow as the second and third largest categories. Grains/Cereals is the weakest performer at $28.6M, despite a comparable order volume (13,910 line items) to higher-earning categories, suggesting a lower average price point rather than a demand problem.

Category	Net Revenue	Line Items
Beverages	$92,163,184	14,828
Confections	$66,337,803	14,895
Meat/Poultry	$64,881,148	13,639
Dairy Products	$58,018,117	14,581
Condiments	$55,795,127	14,682

Seafood	$49,921,604	14,780
Produce	$32,701,120	13,247
Grains/Cereals	$28,568,530	13,910

Product-level detail supports this: Côte de Blaye alone contributed $53.3M — more revenue than the entire Grains/Cereals category — making it the single most important SKU in the catalog. Thüringer Rostbratwurst ($24.6M) and Mishi Kobe Niku ($19.4M) round out the top three individual products.

2. Regional & Country Performance

The United States is the largest single market by shipped revenue, followed closely by Germany and France. Together, the top five markets (USA, Germany, France, Brazil, UK) account for the substantial majority of total company revenue, indicating meaningful customer concentration risk in a small number of geographies.

Country	Net Revenue	Orders
USA	$63,856,338	2,328
Germany	$59,094,757	2,193
France	$49,121,410	1,778
Brazil	$46,250,122	1,683
UK	$36,257,652	1,280
Mexico	$25,438,114	899
Venezuela	$19,320,893	707

3. Sales Team Performance

Revenue attribution across the sales team is unusually balanced — the top five employees by revenue are within a $1.8M band of each other ($49.6M–$51.5M), with no single representative dominating the book of business. Margaret Peacock leads narrowly with $51.5M across 1,908 orders, followed by Steven Buchanan and Janet Leverling. This balance suggests territory/account assignment is working as intended rather than revenue being overly dependent on one or two top performers.

Employee	Net Revenue	Orders
Margaret Peacock	$51,488,395	1,908
Steven Buchanan	$51,386,459	1,804
Janet Leverling	$50,445,574	1,846
Nancy Davolio	$49,659,423	1,846
Robert King	$49,651,899	1,789

4. Shipping & Logistics

Order volume is nearly evenly split across all three shipping partners: United Package (5,486 orders), Federal Shipping (5,461 orders), and Speedy Express (5,335 orders). No single carrier handles a disproportionate share of volume, which limits single-vendor logistics risk but also means there has been no consolidation toward a preferred, potentially lower-cost carrier.

5. Customer Retention & Churn Observations

Northwind does not currently track an explicit churn or cancellation flag at the order level, so retention must be inferred from ordering cadence. Two patterns stand out from this year's review:

Revenue plateau since 2013. After a ramp-up year in 2012 ($18.8M, a partial year), annual revenue has held in a narrow $38M–$41M band for a full decade with no sustained growth trend. A mature customer base with only 93 active accounts and a flat revenue trajectory is consistent with a business that is retaining existing customers but not meaningfully expanding wallet share or acquiring new accounts.

2023 decline warrants monitoring. Revenue for 2023 ($33.1M, partial year through October) is trending below the prior decade's typical range. Because 2023 is not yet a complete calendar year in this dataset, this should be treated as an early signal rather than a confirmed trend — but it is the kind of deviation that ownership and account teams should review account-by-account, since with only 93 total customers, the loss or reduced activity of even a handful of accounts materially moves the aggregate number.

Recommendation: Given the small, concentrated customer base (93 accounts, five countries representing the majority of revenue), a lightweight account health review — ordering frequency and recency by customer — would surface at-risk accounts well before they fully disengage, and is a lower-cost intervention than broad market expansion.

All figures in this report are derived directly from Northwind transactional data (Orders, Order Details, Products, Categories, Employees, Shippers tables) as of the most recent recorded order date in the dataset (October 28, 2023).